The Philippines has a broadband problem

The World Bank measures it on three axes.

33%

ACCESS

Household fixed-broadband penetration. Viet Nam 76%. Malaysia 50%.

11%

AFFORDABILITY

Fixed broadband as share of GNI per capita. Highest in ASEAN.

Low

QUALITY

Median fixed speeds below every major ASEAN peer.

World Bank, "Better Internet for All Filipinos" (January 2024). Ookla (2023, 2025).

Small ISPs carry the expansion

But the margin structure traps them.

FIVE-YEAR AVERAGE, 2017-2022	SMALL ISPS	GLOBE / PLDT
Revenue growth	83%	29%
Net income margin	4%	14%
CAPEX as % of revenue	17%	47%
Wholesale bandwidth as % of revenue	~33%	—

World Bank, 2024, based on PSE and SEC financial statements.

Many small ISPs began as cable TV operators, now running fiber. They can't build faster, cheaper, or

Capability is the lever

Regulatory reform is coming. Capability is controllable today.

Capability → Peering, routing security, IXP participation → Lower bandwidth spend → Restored reinvestment capacity → **Access Affordability Quality**

Reinvestment is what moves the three World Bank indicators.

IXperience Pro

A structured cohort program for provincial Philippine engineers, co-developed with APNIC Academy.

MODULE 1

BGP fundamentals

MODULE 2

Peering and interconnection

MODULE 3

Routing security (RPKI / MANRS)

MODULE 4

IXP operations

4 cohorts × 15 engineers = 60 certified. Train-the-trainer track certifies 4 to 6 Filipino facilitators, so delivery becomes independent of international instructors. All materials publish under Creative Commons.

[PHOTO PLACEHOLDER: past IXperience workshop, participants in learning mode]

Not an experiment

Scaling something already working.

4	155	251	71%
PRIOR EVENTS	COMPANIES	ENGINEERS TRAINED	PROVINCIAL

Curriculum runs on APNIC Academy labs and courseware. With APNIC and PhNOG as co-delivery partners.

2023 ISIF grant delivered: Project School Internet. 50+ schools connected in Cebu, contributing to 100,000+ students.

Standing MOA with FICTAP: RISE serves as the community's designated capability partner for Philippine ISPs.

The loop

→Filipino engineers trained by Filipino engineers

→Lower bandwidth costs

→Restored reinvestment capacity

→Measurable movement on the indicators the World Bank tracks